

Podcast Questions Generator

Reddit Career Discussions Analysis

Generated: 2025-09-27 10:03:50

Posts Analyzed: 19

Files Processed: 19

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY FOR PODCAST PLANNING

Key Insights for Interview Questions:

- 7 major themes identified across career discussions
- 1 controversial topics with high engagement
- 3 common questions and pain points
- Coverage spans 3 different career stages
- Rich source material for authentic, data-driven interview questions

1. MAJOR THEMES FOR PODCAST EPISODES

These themes represent the most discussed topics and could serve as episode themes:

Technical Skills (16 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What's your experience with technical skills?
- What advice would you give about technical skills?
- What are common misconceptions about technical skills?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Advice for moving to a product role as a Senior Software Engineer..."
- "Anyone make the jump from engineering to product management?..."

Product Management (14 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What's your experience with product management?
- What advice would you give about product management?
- What are common misconceptions about product management?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Advice for moving to a product role as a Senior Software Engineer..."
- "Anyone here an actual GTM Engineer?..."

Leadership (14 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What's the difference between being a senior engineer and an engineering manager?
- How do you handle the transition from individual contributor to leader?
- What are the biggest mistakes new engineering managers make?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Anyone make the jump from engineering to product management?..."
- "Been in engineering leadership for a while--ask me anything..."

Career Transition (9 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What was the biggest challenge you faced when transitioning careers?
- How did you know it was time to make a career change?
- What advice would you give to someone considering a similar transition?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Advice for moving to a product role as a Senior Software Engineer..."
- "Been in engineering leadership for a while--ask me anything..."

Compensation (8 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What's your experience with compensation?
- What advice would you give about compensation?
- What are common misconceptions about compensation?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Advice for moving to a product role as a Senior Software Engineer..."
- "Anyone here an actual GTM Engineer?..."

Startup vs Corporate (5 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- How do you decide between a startup CTO role and a director role at a big tech company?
- What are the hidden costs of working at a startup vs. big tech?
- How does the learning curve differ between startup and corporate environments?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "CTO micromanaging and lack of respect for 'chain of command'...."
- "CTO of a small company or Dir of Eng in large and prestigious company..."

Work-Life Balance (2 discussions)

Suggested Podcast Questions:

- What's your experience with work-life balance?
- What advice would you give about work-life balance?
- What are common misconceptions about work-life balance?

Real Discussion Examples:

- "Anyone make the jump from engineering to product management?..."
- "CTO of a small company or Dir of Eng in large and prestigious company..."

2. CONTROVERSIAL TOPICS FOR ENGAGING INTERVIEWS

These topics generated heated discussions and could make for compelling podcast content:

Controversial Topic #1

Title: CTO micromanaging and lack of respect for 'chain of command'.

Engagement Score: 64 comments

Potential Interview Angles:

- What's your take on this controversial perspective?
- Have you seen this debate play out in your career?
- How would you advise someone facing this dilemma?

3. COMMON QUESTIONS & PAIN POINTS

These represent the most frequent concerns - perfect for FAQ-style segments:

Leadership Roles Questions

- try for an internal transfer at my company first, or approach recruiters/hiring managers with this story

General Career Questions

- prioritize
- prioritize

4. CAREER STAGE INSIGHTS FOR TARGETED QUESTIONS

Tailor your questions based on your guest's career stage:

Senior (6 discussions)

- How has the role of senior engineers evolved?
- What's the biggest difference between senior and staff level?
- How do you balance technical depth with broader impact?

Management (13 discussions)

- What's the hardest part about managing other engineers?
- How do you maintain technical credibility as a manager?
- What would you do differently if you started managing again?

Executive (9 discussions)

- How do you stay connected to the technical details as an executive?
- What's the biggest challenge in scaling engineering organizations?
- How do you balance business needs with engineering excellence?

5. DETAILED POSTS FOR DEEP DIVE DISCUSSIONS

High-quality posts that could serve as case studies in interviews:

Case Study #1

Title: Is it realistically possible to become CTO from a frontend engineering background?

Engagement: 90 comments, 140 upvotes

Summary:

First off not all CTO roles are alike. A CTO at a very small startup is likely still a technical expert whereas a CTO at a very large company is very nontechnical. My question is geared more towards the CTO roles at larger companies but would be interested in hearing perspectives as it pertains to ...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #2

Title: CTO micromanaging and lack of respect for 'chain of command'.

Engagement: 63 comments, 151 upvotes

Summary:

Hey, I've worked in startups before but just wondering if I'm being too sensitive or not now. Context: Just started at a not too small startup. I report to the engineering VP. However, the CTO is constantly dismissing his ideas as 'taking too long' and something to do when we 'have more time' and ...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #3

Title: CTO too involved in work, is this normal?

Engagement: 55 comments, 137 upvotes

Summary:

We have a new CTO who is very smart but very much a micro manager. We have about 20 devs with 4 teams of 5. 2 of our team leads recently left so we kind of got absorbed into the other groups. I'm one of the sr devs and I have been tasked with a large project but it has been broken down into quarterl...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #4

Title: Is PM slowly becoming Product Engineering in Big Tech?

Engagement: 58 comments, 109 upvotes

Summary:

I heard that PM might be trending towards Product Engineering, using AI to accelerate development as well as doing PM tasks....

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #5

Title: We have two CTOs

Engagement: 37 comments, 83 upvotes

Summary:

Per title, the company I have been with for a while now has two people with the chief technical officer title. They each have their own areas, but they have overlap. And the CEO is non-technical (and has changed multiple times). We also have at least two, possibly three, development groups that are ...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #6

Title: Been in engineering leadership for a while--ask me anything

Engagement: 65 comments, 26 upvotes

Summary:

I've been leading engineering teams for a while, working closely with product, design, and analytics. I know firsthand how tough it can be to transition into leadership, manage stakeholders, or deal with uncertainty--especially in today's job market. If you're struggling with: * Moving from IC to ...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #7

Title: Can non-technical person fulfill a CTO role?

Engagement: 33 comments, 22 upvotes

Summary:

Hey, The company I am in at the moment is having a rough time. Most teams have trouble on both technical and management fronts. This is also very visible from outside the company: customers are leaving due to the poor quality of the service. I had a conversation with the CEO, he agreed with

the poi...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #8

Title: Anyone here an actual GTM Engineer?

Engagement: 41 comments, 12 upvotes

Summary:

In the latest round of funding Clay boasts 400+ GTME jobs were posted with an average 160k salary. Posted not filled. So curious, how many people here are or even know someone US based who is a full time salaried GTME? How much are you/they making? ...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #9

Title: Do you think SE is a great path to CTO?

Engagement: 39 comments, 9 upvotes

Summary:

I've been debating with colleagues that SE IC to SE leadership could then be a perfect spring board to a career path to CTO. My thoughts are that as an SE you become competent in the technology and product/sales/market fit sides in parallel which to me seems like perfect for someone to be an effecti...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

Case Study #10

Title: Anyone make the jump from engineering to product management?

Engagement: 23 comments, 23 upvotes

Summary:

I'm a senior level SWE with 15 YoE. I currently lead a small team at a larger company, where I've been for the last 5 years. Aside from managerial duties, I occasionally work as an independent contributor and do some hybrid between product and project management. I'm doing well here and have built m...

Interview Questions:

- Have you faced a similar situation in your career?
- What would be your approach to this challenge?
- What advice would you give to someone in this position?

